Universal Human Values — II · 21LEM202T

Unit 4 · Session 1 · SLO 1 — Solved Worksheet

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Unit – 4 : Session – 1 | The Four Orders in Nature

Part C — Long-Answer Questions (Solutions)

• Q1. The FOUR ORDERS in nature: (1) MATERIAL/PHYSICAL ORDER (padarth avastha) — soil, water, metals, air — its characteristic activity is composition/decomposition (units come together and break apart). (2) BIO/PRANIC ORDER (pran avastha) — plants, trees, grass — activity: composition/decomposition PLUS respiration (it breathes, grows — a living body without Self). (3) ANIMAL ORDER (jeev avastha) — insects, fish, birds, cows — activity: composition/decomposition and respiration in the BODY, PLUS selecting/tasting (chayan-svad) in the SELF. (4) HUMAN/KNOWLEDGE ORDER (gyan avastha) — human beings — activity: all of the above PLUS knowing, assuming, recognising, fulfilling and thinking in the Self. Each higher order contains the activities of the lower orders and adds its own.

• Q2. MUTUAL FULFILMENT among the orders: each order participates in the enrichment of the others — soil nourishes plants; plants feed animals and humans and protect soil; animals enrich plants (manure, pollination); humans are meant to protect and enrich all three. The material, pranic and animal orders are ALREADY in harmony by their definite conduct — nature's cycles run without conflict. The human order, WITH right understanding, completes and enriches this web (right utilisation, protection); WITHOUT right understanding, the human fulfils NONE of the orders — polluting soil and water, destroying forests, cruel to animals and exploitative of other humans. The one unit with freedom is the one source of disharmony.

• Q3. Conduct is DEFINITE in the three non-human orders because their activity is governed by their intrinsic nature — a river flows, a seed grows into its species' tree, a cow eats grass; they cannot deviate and hence are always in harmony. The HUMAN being's conduct is INDEFINITE because the human Self has the activity of ASSUMING — and conduct follows the assumption, which can be anything (right or wrong) until it is based on KNOWING. The same human can nurture or destroy; hence human conduct varies while the rest of nature's conduct is fixed.

• Q4. The SOURCE of this indefiniteness is 'ASSUMING WITHOUT KNOWING' — I hold beliefs and images (about myself, others, happiness, nature) that I have never verified through understanding. Acting on unverified assumption, my recognitions and behaviours keep changing with conditioning and circumstance. The moment assuming is anchored in KNOWING (understanding the reality of co-existence as it is), human conduct too becomes definite and harmonious. So the entire work of value education is to convert assuming-without-knowing into assuming-based-on-knowing.